

General Medicine & OTC Reference

Structured reference for a health-assistant RAG system. This document is for general educational guidance and must not be treated as a prescription.

Purpose

This reference contains common symptom categories, commonly used over-the-counter (OTC) medicine classes, their general uses, and basic safety guidance. It is intentionally separate from any Alakart product catalogue.

Symptom / Need	Common OTC option	General use	Important safety note
Fever / mild pain	Paracetamol (acetaminophen)	Reduces fever and relieves mild-to-moderate pain.	Follow the package dose. Avoid taking multiple products containing paracetamol.
Fever / pain / inflammation	Ibuprofen	Reduces fever, pain, and inflammation.	Avoid or seek professional advice with stomach ulcers, significant kidney or liver disease, or concurrent blood thinners.
Dry cough	Dextromethorphan	Temporarily suppresses a dry cough.	Check other medicines before use; follow package directions.
Nasal allergy symptoms	Cetirizine	Helps relieve sneezing, runny nose, and itching caused by allergies.	May cause drowsiness in some people.
Blocked nose	Saline nasal spray	Moisturizes nasal passages and helps loosen mucus.	Generally a low-risk supportive option; use as directed.
Acid reflux / heartburn	Antacid	Provides short-term relief of heartburn and acid indigestion.	Check for drug interactions and separate from some medicines when taking.
Diarrhea	Oral rehydration solution (ORS)	Replaces fluids and electrolytes lost through diarrhea.	Seek care for severe dehydration, blood in stool, or persistent symptoms.
Constipation	Psyllium / bulk-forming fiber	Adds bulk and water to stool to support bowel movements.	Take with adequate water; persistent or severe constipation requires medical attention.
Minor muscle / joint pain	Topical analgesic	Can provide temporary local relief of minor aches and pains.	Use only on intact and avoid damaged skin.

General response rules for the RAG assistant

- Do not present general OTC medicines as Alakart products.
- Only mention an Alakart product when that product is retrieved from the Alakart product catalogue.
- If no relevant Alakart product is retrieved, explicitly say that no matching Alakart product was found in the available catalogue.
- Give simple, point-wise general guidance before any Alakart option when the user asks for an Alakart solution.
- Do not invent dosage, indications, ingredients, or product claims that are absent from the retrieved source data.
- For children, pregnancy, older adults, chronic conditions, allergies, multiple medicines, severe symptoms, or uncertain diagnosis, recommend professional medical advice rather than making a confident treatment recommendation.

When to seek medical attention

- Difficulty breathing, chest pain, fainting, confusion, seizures, or severe weakness.
- Severe allergic reaction such as facial/throat swelling or difficulty breathing.
- Very high, persistent, or worsening fever, especially with serious symptoms.
- Blood in vomit or stool, severe dehydration, or inability to keep fluids down.
- Symptoms that are persistent, rapidly worsening, or concerning to the user.

Important disclaimer

This reference is intended for general educational and retrieval purposes. It does not diagnose illness or replace a clinician's advice. Medicine selection and dosing depend on age, medical history, allergies, other medicines, pregnancy status, and the specific condition. Users should follow the product label and seek advice from a qualified healthcare professional when appropriate.